Carboplatin + Oral Etoposide

Carboplatin is planned into a vein on Day 1, before oral etoposide. Etoposide capsules are prescribed twice daily on Days 1, 2 and 3 only, on an empty stomach. The cycle repeats every 21 days while treatment is helping and side effects remain acceptable. Your team decides when to delay, change or stop; the source does not set a fixed number of cycles.

Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending. Selected effects; not a complete medicine leaflet.

A picture of side effects

Numbered symptom boxes connect to the anatomical illustration. The medicine responsible may be uncertain; report the symptom.

1 Ears / hearing

Carboplatin

Report tinnitus or hearing change promptly.

2 Mouth

Both medicines

Report ulcers or painful swallowing; poor intake can need urgent support.

3 Chest / breathing

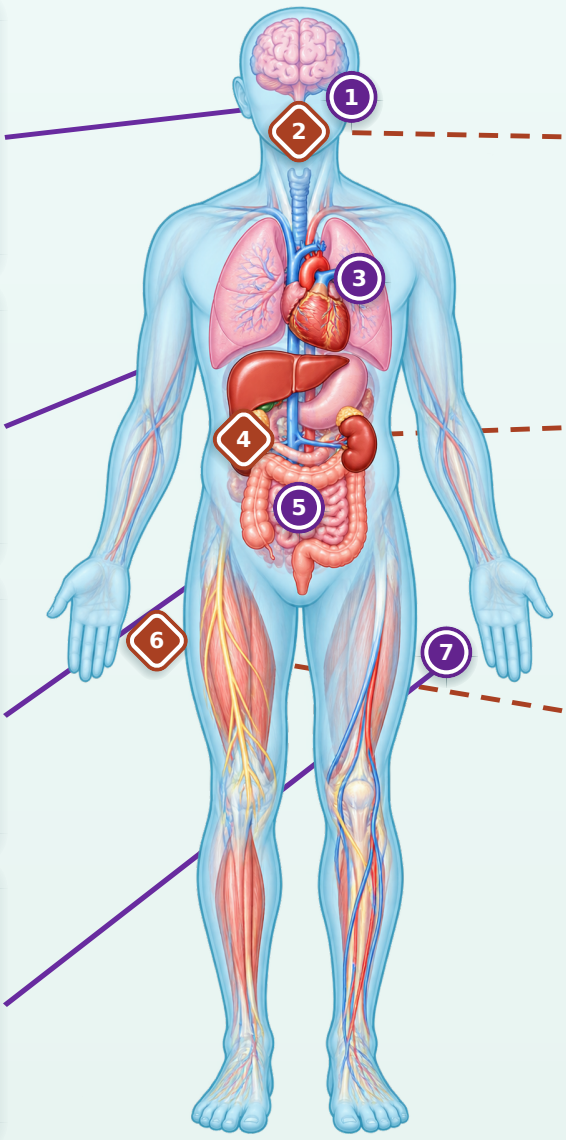
Both medicines

New breathlessness, chest pain or allergic swelling needs urgent assessment.

4 Kidneys / fluids

Carboplatin

Report reduced urine or inability to drink; kidney tests guide dosing.



5 Stomach / bowel

Both medicines

Use the prescribed sickness plan; call about persistent vomiting or diarrhoea.

6 Hands / feet

Carboplatin

Report tingling, numbness, weakness or balance problems.

7 Skin / blood counts

Both medicines

Report severe rash, fever, bruising or bleeding.

Selected effects, not every possible effect or a prediction. Blood-count, skin and line markers are schematic. Number and text carry meaning; colour is decorative.

> Fever, shivers or suddenly unwell: contact oncology immediately. Severe chest pain, breathing difficulty, collapse or seizure: 112 / 999.

Your treatment, at home.

Important medicine-specific effects

Carboplatin

- Low blood counts, infection and bleeding
- Nausea, vomiting and fatigue
- Mouth soreness and diarrhoea
- Kidney problems
- Allergic or infusion reactions
- Hearing changes or tinnitus, which can persist
- Numbness or tingling, which can persist

Oral etoposide

- Low blood counts, infection and bleeding
- Nausea, vomiting, diarrhoea and mouth soreness
- Hair loss and fatigue
- Allergic reactions
- Fertility effects
- Rare serious skin reactions
- Secondary leukaemia can occur

Surgery, radiation and monitoring: open the whole-treatment map or scan the QR.

Make the plan practical

Your capsule prescription

Follow the prescribed capsule count and twice-daily Days 1–3 schedule exactly, using the written calendar to record each dose. Take capsules on an empty stomach with water; ask the pharmacist to explain the timing around food. Do not chew, open or crush capsules. If swallowing is difficult, contact the team before taking them; do not substitute an intravenous preparation or change the dose yourself.

Missed or vomited doses

If a dose is missed, do not double the next dose or extend the course. The manufacturer leaflet advises taking the next dose when due; inform your oncology pharmacist/team and follow your written plan. If you vomit after a dose, contact the team for instructions rather than automatically taking replacement capsules. BC Cancer specifically advises no repeat dose after vomiting within one hour unless the healthcare team directs it. Persistent vomiting or inability to keep fluids down needs urgent advice.

Safe handling and storage

Keep capsules in their original pack, away from children and excess heat or damp, following the supplied label. The manufacturer leaflet advises gloves for handling and washing hands afterwards. Do not open a blister with a leaking capsule; ask the pharmacist what to do. Return unused capsules through the pharmacy; do not put them in household waste or drains.

Sickness prevention across several days

Carboplatin Day 1 has high sickness risk; the oral etoposide-only days have a different risk. Your team provides one clear prevention and rescue plan covering treatment days and the next two days. Some medicines overlap; take only the reconciled prescription and do not repeat the full Day 1 plan on your own.

Fluids and symptom reporting

Ask for a drinking plan appropriate to your heart and kidney health. Report inability to drink or reduced urine promptly. Keep mouth-care advice and the emergency number nearby.

Other medicines and vaccines

Show the team all prescribed and non-prescribed medicines, supplements and vaccines. Etoposide has important interactions. Check before adding or stopping medicines; ask about contraception and fertility before treatment.

Emergency: 112 / 999. Severe breathing difficulty, collapse, seizure or severe chest pain needs emergency help.

Contact oncology immediately for temperature ≥37.5°C or ≤36°C, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your own hospital's instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment.

YOUR ONCOLOGY TEAM · DAYTIME

Insert numbers here

Acute Oncology Service

YOUR ONCOLOGY TEAM · OUT OF HOURS

Insert numbers here

Ask for medical oncology

EVENINGS / OVERNIGHT

Your out-of-hours pathway / nearest ED

Other hospitals: use the numbers your team provides.

Complete reference, visual timeline and passport

https://sactcheck.com/patient/00319/

Sources and review status are available online. Follow your own prescription and hospital instructions.